camouflage cam · ou · flage

Advanced Definition

noun

1. a method of concealing something such as a person, vehicle, or building, esp. from an enemy military force, by covering it or coloring it so as to imitate its surroundings.

   Camouflage is crucial to the defense of any army.
   The coats of many animals serve them as a natural form of camouflage.

2. the material, such as paint, fabric, or foliage, used to conceal something by this method.

   The soldiers covered their vehicles with camouflage.

3. any method of disguising for the purpose of concealing.

   His apparent calmness was camouflage for his real fears.

transitive verb

1. to conceal by coloring or covering to imitate the surroundings.

   In winter the soldiers camouflaged themselves by wearing white.

2. to conceal by disguising.

   She camouflaged her true motives.

Spanish cognate

camuflaje: The Spanish word *camuflaje* means camouflage.

These are some examples of how the word or forms of the word are used:

1. The peppered moth was light in color and had speckled wings. It was hard to pick out against many of the trees and buildings in England and could camouflage itself easily.
2. Startled onlookers watched as a veiled chameleon climbed up a tree branch and changed color. The chameleon's ability to camouflage, or conceal itself by changing its appearance, helps the creature hide from predators and curious museum-goers.
3. The okapi is only one-third as tall as a giraffe with a shorter neck. It's also a solitary animal; except for mothers and infants, okapis keep to themselves. And then there are the zebra-like stripes on its legs and hind flanks, which serve as camouflage. Camouflage is a disguise that protects an animal from predators—in the okapi's world, leopards.
4. Penguins are a type of bird that live mostly in water. Their black and white appearance is known as countershading, which is a form of camouflage that helps keep them safe in the water.
5. Another way animals adapt to life in the rainforest is by camouflaging themselves to hide from predators. An insect called the

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"walking stick" lives in the palm tree, and it blends in so well with it that it's practically unnoticeable unless it moves. When they close their wings, some butterflies look identical to leaves, which masks them from predators.

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